

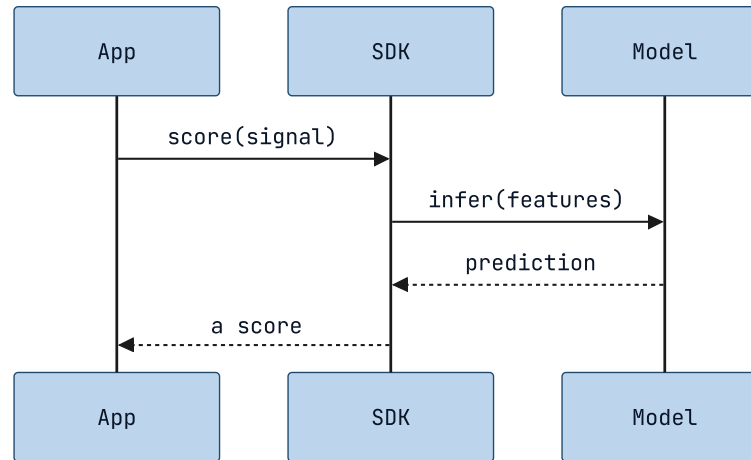
MERMAID SEQUENCEDIAGRAM NARRATION

Read-aloud that reads the conversation.

A `diagram` slide's sequence diagram used to narrate its heading and go silent. Now read-aloud (and the exported captions) walk the message script in source order — naming each participant, reading every author's message label, and speaking single-level blocks as connectives — the first Mermaid type past the flowchart (design 2026-07-14, first-wave slice #1).

01 • THE MESSAGE SCRIPT

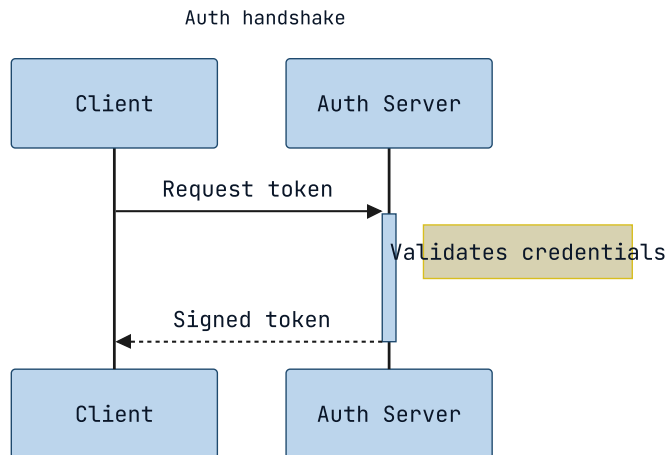
Each message, in the order it was sent.

**KEY INSIGHT**

The reading opens with the frame — "A sequence diagram." — then walks the messages in source order: "App sends to SDK: score(signal). SDK sends to Model: infer(features). Model sends to SDK: prediction. SDK sends to App: a score." An undeclared id reads as its own name.

02 • PARTICIPANTS AND NOTES

Aliases name the speaker; a note is read in place.

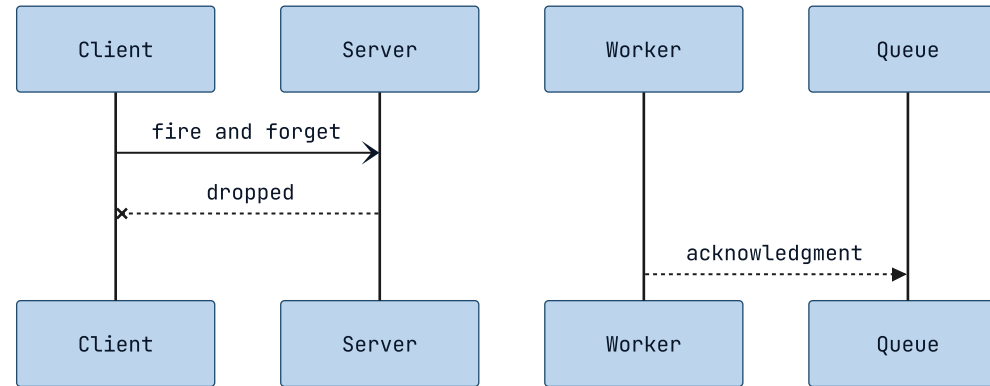


KEY INSIGHT

A **participant ... as** alias speaks the display label, not the id: "Client sends to Auth Server: Request token." A single-line note reads as "Note: Validates credentials." The **+**/**-** activation flags are lifeline bookkeeping — silent, never spoken.

03 • EVERY ARROW IS NEUTRAL

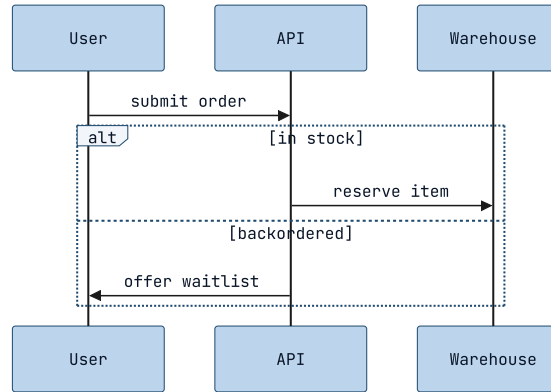
The glyph's sync/async/reply meaning is never voiced.

**KEY INSIGHT**

A solid, dashed, async, or lost arrow all read as the same neutral "sends to" — the glyph encodes sync/async/reply only by Mermaid *convention*, not authored content, so verbalizing it would be fabrication. Only the label after the colon is the author's meaning: "Client sends to Server: fire and forget. Server sends to Client: dropped. Worker sends to Queue: acknowledgment."

04 • A BLOCK AS A CONNECTIVE

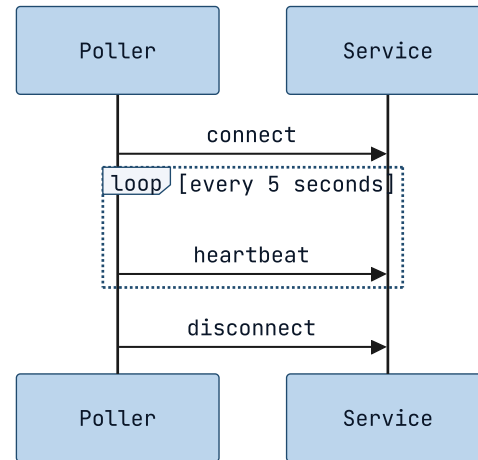
A loop or alternative frames the messages inside it.

**KEY INSIGHT**

A single-level **loop**, **alt** / **else**, **opt**, **par**, **critical**, or **break** is spoken as a lead-in so the next message reads inside it. A first **alt** opens with "If <cond>:" — never "Alternatively" (which would imply a prior option): "User sends to API: submit order. If in stock: API sends to Warehouse: reserve item. Otherwise, if backordered: API sends to User: offer waitlist."

05 • LEAVING A BLOCK

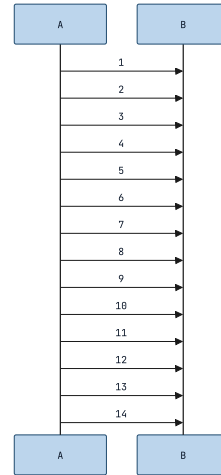
A message after the block resumes at the top level.

**KEY INSIGHT**

When a block closes and more follows, the reading marks the return so the trailing message isn't heard as still inside the loop: "Poller sends to Service: connect. Repeatedly, every 5 seconds: Poller sends to Service: heartbeat. Afterwards: Poller sends to Service: disconnect."

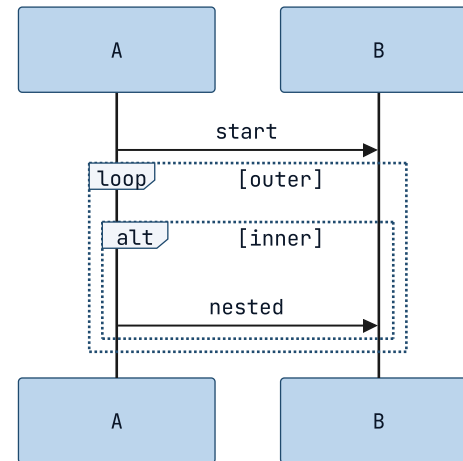
06 • A LONG SCRIPT STAYS LISTENABLE

Past a cap, the first messages read and the rest are counted.

**KEY INSIGHT**

A wall of messages would drown a listener, so past a twelve-message cap the reading speaks the first twelve faithfully, then folds the remainder into a count: "... A sends to B: 12. And two more messages." A prefix beats discarding the whole script for a bare total.

What the parser can't read faithfully, it doesn't guess.



KEY INSIGHT

A nested block, a multiline `note ... end note`, or a line the parser doesn't recognize returns nothing — the slide falls back to its heading and this caption, exactly as before. No confidently-wrong reading of a script the narrator can't yet parse; deeper structure graduates in a later slice.

The conversation is spoken now.

*sequenceDiagram · messages in order ·
every arrow neutral · read-aloud + exported
captions*